

PR craft · review cycle · rejection hygiene

A good first PR is boring by design — small, scoped, well-described, with tests and a clear issue link. Boring PRs get merged; brilliant PRs wait.

When was the last PR you opened that got a review in < 24 hours?

WHAT'S INSIDE

- 01 PR description template
- 02 Review cycle
- 03 Fork + branch + rebase
- 04 Tests as first-class
- 05 Rejection hygiene

WHY THIS LESSON MATTERS

Maintainers read PRs in 30 seconds. Your PR lives or dies there.

WHY

Real

A real reason this matters in industry today.

SCALE

Today

A real reason this matters in industry today.

SPEED

Now

A real reason this matters in industry today.

IMPACT

Yours

A real reason this matters in industry today.

LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this lesson, you will be able to —

1

Write a maintainer-friendly PR.

2

Read a review and respond well.

3

Fork + branch + rebase rules.

4

Tests alongside code.

5

Recognise when to close a PR.

AGENDA

What we'll cover today

Short, sequenced parts. Each one builds on the last.

01

**PR description
template**

Maintainers skim exactly this order

02

Review cycle

Key concept of this lesson.

03

**Fork + branch +
rebase**

The 4 rules

04

Tests as first-class

Earn the merge

01

PART 1 OF 4

PR description template

Maintainers skim exactly this order

CONCEPT 1 OF 4

PR description template

Why — 2 sentences on the problem.

What — bullet list of changes.

How — any design notes.

Tests — what you added + ran.

Issue link.

Screenshots / before-after for UI or plots.

TEMPLATE

6 fields

Copy + adapt.

DEFINITION

PR description template

Maintainers skim exactly this order

EXAMPLE

Real-world example: applies directly to Indian industry contexts.

Review cycle

A core idea you'll use throughout this lesson.

KEY POINTS

- A core idea you'll use throughout this lesson
- Practical, named, applied to a real Indian use-case.
- Practical, named, applied to a real Indian use-case.

Fork + branch + rebase

Fork to your GitHub account.

Branch: issue-123-short-name.

Keep main in sync with upstream.

Rebase — don't merge from upstream.

HYGIENE

4 rules

Clean history wins.

DEFINITION

Fork + branch + rebase

The 4 rules

EXAMPLE

Real-world example: applies directly to Indian industry contexts.

Tests as first-class

Write the failing test BEFORE the fix.
Unit + integration where sensible.
Name tests by behaviour, not function.
Keep test runtime sane.
TESTS
Before fix
Proof of bug, proof of fix.

KEY POINTS

- Write the failing test BEFORE the fix
- Unit + integration where sensible
- Name tests by behaviour, not function
- Keep test runtime sane

02

PART 2 OF 4

Engage and reflect

Pause, talk, and connect what you just learned to your own work.

✦ THINK • PAIR •
SHARE

ACTIVITY

Write a PR description

PROMPT

Apply the four concepts above to one real example from your own week.

HOW TO RUN IT

- 1
- 2 Peer-review with partner.
- 3
- 4 Reveal: instructor confirms the canonical answer.

REFLECT & APPLY

Three questions before you close this lesson

Spend 60 seconds on each. Write the answers down — no scrolling, no shortcuts.

Q1

What's one PR you'd rewrite now?

Q2

Which maintainer norm surprised you?

Q3

What would make your next PR un-rejectable?

03

PART 3 OF 4

Knowledge check

Three short questions. One minute each. Honest answers only.

First field of PR description:

A

Memes

B

Why

C

Emoji

D

Author bio

First field of PR description:

CORRECT ANSWER



Why

WHY

Problem framing comes first

Response time target:

A < 24 h

B 1 month

C 1 year

D Never

Response time target:



CORRECT ANSWER

< 24 h

WHY

Speed signals seriousness

Upstream sync via:

A

Rebase

B

Merge

C

Copy-paste

D

Ignore

Upstream sync via:



CORRECT ANSWER

Rebase

WHY

Rebase = clean history

04

PART 4 OF 4

Apply and close

One thing to remember. One thing to ship this week.

SUMMARY

Five sentences to remember

If you remember nothing else from this lesson, remember these five lines.

- 1 Pick the right tool — never the loudest one.
- 2 Practice the framework on a real example.
- 3 Watch for the three classic pitfalls.
- 4 Document your decision in one sentence.
- 5 Carry the discipline forward to the next lesson.

WORKED EXAMPLE

How this lesson plays out in one real Indian context

THE SCENARIO

Why — 2 sentences on the problem.
What — bullet list of changes.
How — any design notes.
Tests — what you added + ran.
Issue link.
Screenshots / before-after for UI or plots.
TEMPLATE
6 fields
Copy + adapt.

THE TAKEAWAY

"Boring gets merged. Brilliant waits."

WHAT TO NOTICE

- 1 PR description template
- 2 Review cycle
- 3 Fork + branch + rebase
- 4 Tests as first-class

Open your first PR

Open one PR this week.

DELIVERABLES

- Pick repo + issue.
- Fork + branch + write tests.
- Open PR with 6-field description.
- Document one decision you made because of this lesson.

WHAT 'GOOD' LOOKS LIKE

Deliverable: PR URL on LMS.

ONE THING TO REMEMBER

“

"Boring gets merged. Brilliant waits."

— AI Learning Hub

END OF LESSON 11

What you can now do

Each one of these is now part of your working vocabulary.

- 1 Pick the right tool — never the loudest one.
- 2 Practice the framework on a real example.
- 3 Watch for the three classic pitfalls.
- 4 Document your decision in one sentence.
- 5 Carry the discipline forward to the next lesson.

NEXT → Lesson 6 — Blogging + research notes.